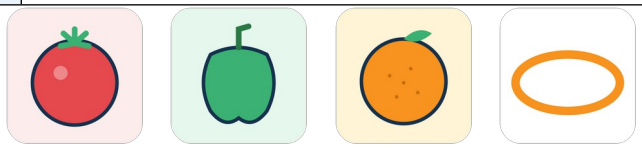
02 · Lesson spec

Sorting is Smart · 40 minutes · whole class, then groups · fully unplugged

Goal	**I can sort things by one rule and say my rule.**
Core parts	Move + Code
Key words	sort · group · same · different · rule
Materials	2–3 hoops or chalk circles; a basket of big objects (fruit pictures, big blocks, large counters); sorting picture cards (Printables); red, blue and yellow cards; optional junk boxes as bins



1. Watch (5 min)

- **Show a mixed basket of fruit pictures (tomatoes, peppers, bananas and corn). Say: "Ayo's market basket is mixed up! How can he put them in groups?"**
- Take ideas. Sort them by colour into hoops, saying: "My **rule** is colour. All the red ones go **here**."
- **Hand signs:** sort = move hands left and right · group = circle your arms · same = point to two matching things · different = shake head · rule = hold up one finger like a teacher.

2. Do in groups (25 min)

a) Sorting robots, whole class (8 min) · Core: Move

- Lay 2–3 hoops on the floor. Children carry big objects to the hoop of the same colour.
- Then give each child a red, blue or yellow card; they walk to the matching hoop.

b) Sort the cards, groups (12 min) · Core: Code

- Groups sort picture cards into 2–3 groups by one rule and **say the rule**: colour, shape, or animal / not animal.
- Mix the cards and sort them again by a **different** rule. Same cards, new groups!
- **Practical:** each group sorts a basket of big objects; **another group guesses the rule**.
- **Stretch:** sort by two features (red circles, red squares, blue circles, blue squares).

c) Activity Book page (5 min)

- Draw lines to put each object in its group. Not marked.

3. Share (10 min)

- **Create:** draw a group of things that are all the same colour.
- Optional Build: label junk boxes as sorting bins for the classroom.
- **Close:** "Sorting is smart! Computers sort things using rules too."

Common mistakes

- Changing the rule halfway (a red square in the circle group) → "What is our rule? Colour or shape?"
- Sorting without saying the rule → always finish with "My rule is…"

What if it doesn't work?

- No hoops → chalk circles, skipping ropes, or sheets of paper.

- Too many objects → start with 6 items and 2 groups.

Support and stretch

- **Support:** 2 groups by colour only; the teacher holds up the first item for each group.
- **Stretch** (optional, never assessed): sort by two features.

How we check

Observation only. Tick each child who **sorts objects by one feature and says the rule**.

> **Safety**
> Nothing smaller than a toilet-roll tube opening. Walk to the hoops. Hoops flat on the floor.